

Assignment submission instructions

ECSE 420: Parallel Computing

Submission contents

All assignments must be submitted through *myCourses*. A submission should consist of a single .zip file with the following naming structure:

Student1LastName_ Student1Id_Student2LastName_ Student2Id_Assignment#.zip

For example:

Mark Rubin SID 123456789 and Catherine Smith SID 987654321 are submitting assignment 1. There zip folder would have the following name:

Rubin_123456789_Smith_987654321_Assignment1.zip

Source files

Submitted source files are expected to compile and run without error.

When creating source files, they should be placed inside a correctly named java package. The proper naming to follow is “ca.mcgill.ecse420.a#” where # is replaced by the corresponding assignment number.

Zip folder contents

The zip folder must contain the following:

1. A report (in .pdf format) answering the questions in the assignment
2. *.java source files in their correct package structures, which includes all folders
 - a. ca/mcgill/ecse420/a#/*.java
3. Any input files related to the assignment

Note, this zip does not contain any *.class or *.prj, *.project, or other files. Only submit what is requested in the assignment.

Report PDF file

The report pdf must contain your groups' names and student IDs. The pdf should answer all the questions asked in the assignment. For code related questions, it should refer to the appropriate source files and include any input and output passed or generated by the code. The report should be well-formatted and easy to read. Please be explicit about which question you are answering.

The PDF file must have an **appendix** that contains all the source code. This can be used for referencing code when answering questions. Note, you still must submit the source files as well. In addition, the PDF file must include an **AI Use Disclosure Appendix** in accordance with the requirements described below. This appendix must be included even if no AI tools were used during completion of the assignment.



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Use of Generative Artificial Intelligence (AI) Tools

The use of Generative Artificial Intelligence (AI) tools in ECSE 420 is governed by the AI-use statement provided in the course outline. Generative Artificial Intelligence (AI) tools may be used in this course, unless otherwise specified for a particular assessment, to support activities such as generating code examples, explaining concepts, assisting with debugging, suggesting test cases, and improving documentation. Students remain fully responsible for all submitted work. Any code, analysis, explanations, documentation, or other materials obtained from AI tools must be critically evaluated, tested, verified, and understood prior to submission. Students are strongly encouraged to use McGill University's institutional Microsoft Copilot service when utilizing AI tools for course-related activities. The use of AI tools does not transfer responsibility for submitted work to the AI system. Students remain responsible for the correctness, completeness, testing, performance, and technical content of all submitted work.

AI Use Disclosure Appendix

Each assignment report must include an **AI Use Disclosure Appendix**.

If no AI tools were used during completion of the assignment, students should explicitly state:

No AI tools were used in the completion of this assignment.

If AI tools were used, the appendix must contain the following information:

AI Tool(s) Used

List all AI tools used during completion of the assignment (e.g., Microsoft Copilot, GitHub Copilot, ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, etc).

Nature of Use

Briefly describe how the AI tool(s) were used (e.g., concept explanations, code generation, debugging assistance, test-case generation, documentation assistance, performance-analysis suggestions, etc.).

Verification Activities

Briefly describe how any AI-generated content was tested, verified, and validated before being incorporated into the submitted work (e.g., unit testing, manual code inspection, performance benchmarking, comparison against theoretical expectations, validation against known-correct implementations, etc.).

Reflection

Briefly discuss:

1. One useful contribution provided by the AI tool.
2. One limitation, incorrect assumption, error, or misleading suggestion encountered.
3. How the issue was identified and resolved.

The **AI Use Disclosure Appendix** should normally not exceed one page in length.

Questions regarding the appropriate use or disclosure of AI tools should be directed to the instructor before submission whenever there is uncertainty.



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Source code style and formatting

Submitted source code must be well formatted, easy to understand, and should follow the [Google Java Style Guide](#). Well formatted code means there is no strange spacing, new lines, or garbage characters. Also, it should be well commented and use meaningful variable names.

For example:

Good:

```
package ca.mcgill.ecse420.a1;

public class Question1 {

    public static void main(String[] args) {

        String myName = "Dirk Dubois"; // My name to be displayed on the console
        System.out.println(myName); // Outputs my name to the console

    }

}
```

The above code is well formatted, uses proper variable names, follows the style guide and is readable. It also uses the correct spacing and indentation.

Bad:

```
package ca.mcgill.ecse420.a1;

public class writes_name_to_console {

    public static void main(String[] args) {

        String B10h3a = "Dirk Dubois";
        String blah2 = B10h3a;

        System.out.println(blah2);    }
}
```

The above code is poorly formatted, uses variable names that violate the style guide and is not very readable. The class name is incorrect, the indentation is incorrect, variable names are hard to understand and do not follow the naming conventions, and finally the brackets are incorrect. It also does not have any code comments to help explain its objective.

Verification of Understanding

As indicated in the course outline, the instructor and teaching assistants reserve the right to conduct brief follow-up discussions, demonstrations, or audits with selected teams regarding any aspect of their submitted work, including source code, experimental results, analyses, conclusions, testing procedures, and AI-use disclosures. Students are expected to be able to explain and justify all submitted work.



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